STUDENT' NAME _____ CLASS_____

NORTHERN EDUCATION DIVISION

2025 MALAWI SCHOOL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION MOCK EXAMINATION

AGRICULTURE

Date**: Thursday, 27th March** **Subject number: M012/I**

Time allowed: 2hrs

8:00-10:00am

PAPER I

(100 marks)

Theory

Instructions:

1. This paper contains **11 printed pages. Please check.**
2. This paper has **two** sections **A** and **B**. Section **A** has **ten** questions and section **B three** sections.
3. Answer **all** questions in the spaces provided.
4. Write your **name** on all pages.
5. In the table**, tick** against a question you have answered
6. At the end of examination, hand in your paper the invigilator.

Questions	Tick if answered	Do not write in this column
1		
2		
3		
4		
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9		
10		
11		
12		
13		

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SECTION A (70 MARKS)

Answer **all** questions.

1. a. Give any **two** cultivated species of mushrooms.

_____

_____ (2 marks)

b. Describe soil porosity.

_____

_____(2 marks)

c. Describe the following forms of soil degradation.

i. Chemical degradation.

_____

_____

_____(2 marks)

ii. Physical degradation.

_____

_____

_____(2 marks)

2. a. Give any **two** importance of livestock improvement.

_____

_____ (2 marks)

b. Describe the following vegetative planting materials.

i. Stem cuttings.

_____

_____

_____ (2 marks)

ii. Suckers.

_____

_____

_____(2 marks)

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3. a. Give any **two** ways in which trading of agricultural commodities is important at community level

(i)

_____(1 mark)

(ii)

_____ (1 mark)

b. Farmer X sold dressed chickens to Chipiku stores. A restaurant owner bought 1 packet of these dressed chickens from Chipiku, the chicken was then prepared and later sold to a customer.

i. With a well labelled diagram show the market channel taken by the product mentioned in the information provided in question **3**.b. above.

(3 marks)

ii. Name the type of marketing channel shown in **3**.b.i above.

_____(1 mark)

c. Explain any **two** factors that affect the nutrient status of soil.

(i)

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_____(2 marks)

(ii)

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_____ (2 marks)

4.a. Describe any **two** poor farming practices which encourage water loss.

(i)

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_____ (2 marks)

(ii)

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_____(2 marks)

b. Describe any **one** way in which rotational grazing would help to control ticks.

_____

_____(2 marks)

5. a. Explain **one** way in which mixed cropping would ensure food security at house hold level.

_____

_____ (2 marks)

b. Explain any **one** way in which the following measures would reduce the impacts of climate change.

(i) Conservation agriculture

_____

_____(2 marks)

(ii) water harvesting

_____

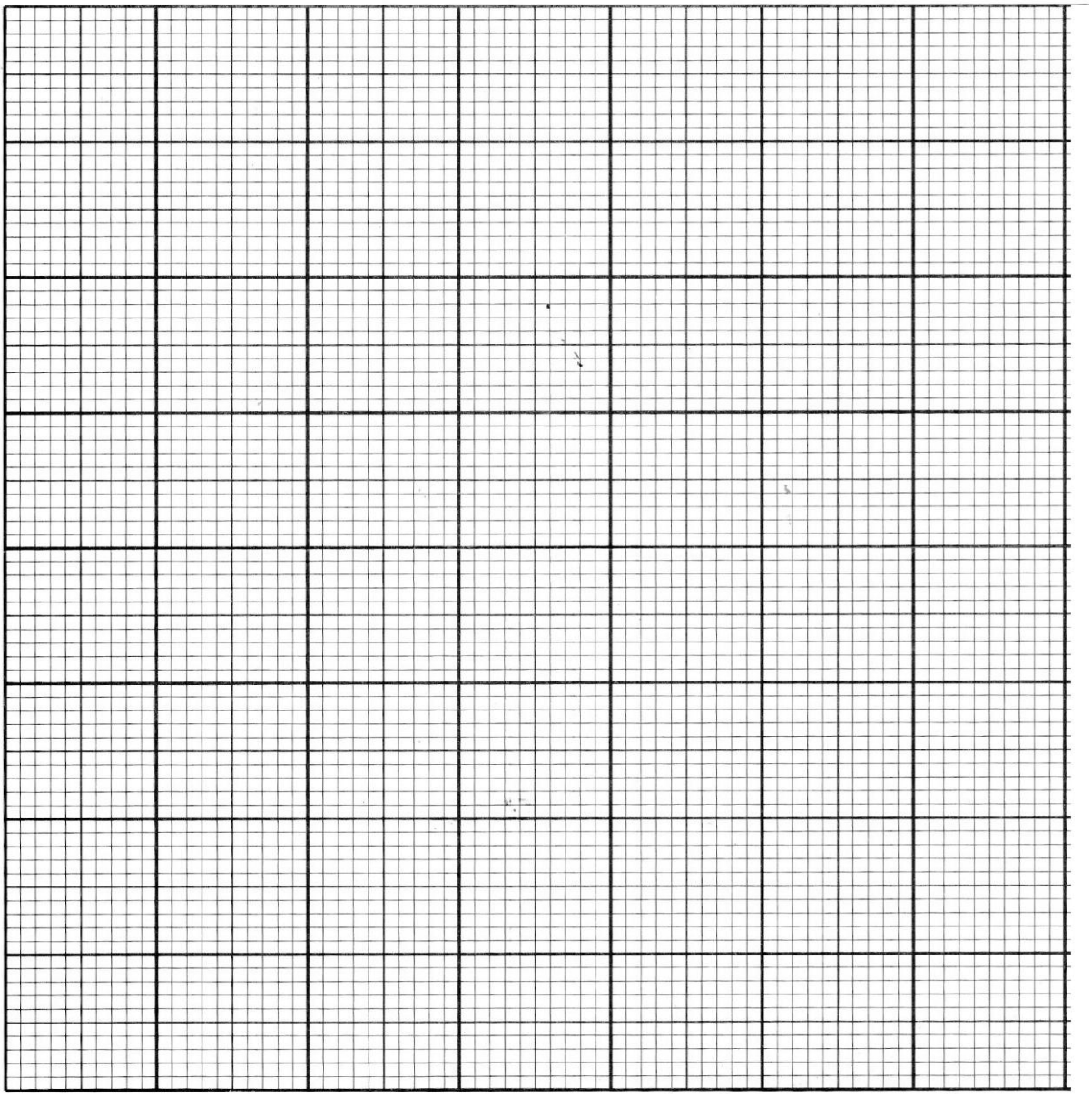
_____(2 marks)

6. **Table below** shows results of an experiment on the effect of fertiliser rate on maize yield. Use it to answer the questions that follow.

Table 1

Fertiliser rate (kg/ha)	Yield (kg)	Marginal return (kg)
0	1000	0
100	1700	700
200	3000	1300
300	5000	2000
400	7000	2000
500	7500	500
600	7600	100
700	7600	0

a. Plot a graph of yield against fertiliser rate.



(5 marks)

b. From the graph, what is the best fertiliser rate that can be recommended for growing maize.

_____(1 mark)

c. Give a reason for your answer in **7 b**.

_____

_____ (2 marks)

d. State the economic principle which has been illustrated on the graph.

_____ (1 mark)

7. **Figure 1** is a diagram showing a livestock parasite. Use it to answer questions that follow.

Figure 1

a. Name the parasite

_____(1 mark)

b. Describe any **one** effect of the parasite on livestock production

_____

_____(2 marks)

c. Give any **two** ways of controlling the parasite named in 5 a.

_____

_____ (2marks)

8. Table 1 shows milk produced by three different cows kept by a farmer

Cow No	Milk produced per day			
	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4
1	6	4	7	9
2	7	5	6	3
3	3	6	4	7

a. Name the type of record kept by the farmer

_____(1 mark)

b. Which of these cows should be culled? Show your working

(4marks)

c. Calculate income obtained in day 3 if the milk was sold at K1,200 per litre

(2 marks)

d. State any **two** reasons for keeping such a record on a farm

_____

_____

_____**(2 marks)**

9. Draw the reproductive organ of a **cow** and label any **two** parts.

(3 marks)

10. A Farmer kept the following record. Use it to answer questions that follow

- Sold 45 bags of maize at K50,000/bag
- Paid casual labour K108,000
- Bought 5kg seed at K8,000 per kg
- Bought 4 bags of fertilizer at K120,000 each.

Prepare a financial record (8 marks).

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SECTION B (30 marks)

Answer all the **three** question in this section. Your answers should be in essay form.

11. Describe any **five** management practices that are done when rearing calves.

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_____ (10 marks)

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12. Explain any **five** ways in which agricultural cooperatives are important to farmers.

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_____(10 marks)

13. Describe any **five** effects of gender biases in agricultural technology.

(10marks)

END OF QUESTION PAPER.